

Anthropology 151

Emerging Humanity

Online Asynchronous

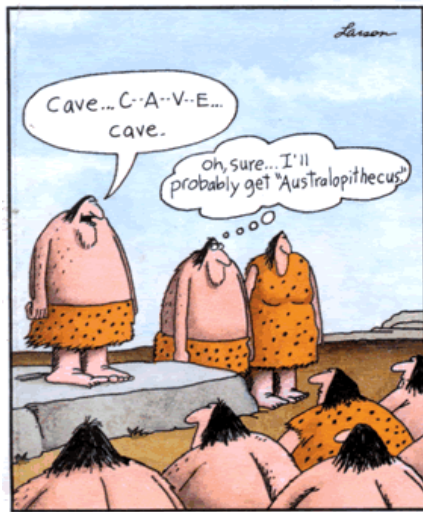
Instructor: Daniel Cusimano

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Office: Saunders 330

Office Hours: M/W 10:00-11:00

Available for Zoom meetings (email for scheduling)



Primitive spelling bees

COURSE DESCRIPTION: Emerging Humanity is a course designed to provide students with a broad understanding of how we, as humans, got to where we are today. We thus step through time to engage in key moments of our biological and cultural evolution in this course's three units. Unit one, unsurprisingly, starts with our evolutionary history. Students will learn about fossil populations, human adaptations, and the emergence of material culture. Unit two explores how our species, *Homo sapiens* spread across the globe with cultural innovations such as agriculture and the political economy. Our final unit dives into the emergence of complex societies ultimately leading to where we are today. This class engages with the four primary sub-fields of anthropology (Biological Anthropology, Archaeology, Linguistics, and Cultural Anthropology), and therefore also provides students with an

idea of what pursuing an anthropology career/degree could look like.

- **REQUIRED TEXTS:**

Unit One: Explorations: An Open Invitation to Biological Anthropology

<https://explorations.americananthro.org/>

Unit Two:

Unit Three:

- **PRESENTATION:** As an online asynchronous course there is not much that can be done for presentation. In the past I have recorded my lectures for students to watch but...let's be real, watching a couple of 45-minute lectures over a variety of Power Points is not likely to happen. Not for the majority at least. So here's the plan: no structured presentation. This puts a lot of responsibility on you to keep up with the reading and a lot of responsibility on me to

provide you with some additional content to help explain difficult concepts (and attempt to make the material more interesting for you). Thus, you will have weekly reading assignment. To help you along with these I will post short (very short) videos of me awkwardly talking through some important points. I will try to keep these videos under 5 minutes each. PLEASE WATCH THEM.

- **COURSE REQUIREMENTS:** Other than reliable internet access, the only thing that you will have to be able to use is PowerPoint or equivalent slide presentation builder (See Exams section below).
 - Power Point- You will need to be able to build a presentation and add presenter notes
 - Google Slides- This is a free alternative to PowerPoint that I am less familiar with. From what I can see it functions the same way and you can export presentations in the PowerPoint format (.ppt)
- **CLASS PARTICIPATION:** There really isn't much for you to do here with the online asynch format. That said, I do like to hear from students. Please reach out to me with questions and/or schedule office hours. Additionally, I will post a couple of discussion boards for students to use. I realize that discussion boards are not a widely used feature for students but they are a good tool. I will open general question threads for each unit and exam. An active discussion board would pretty well guarantee success for all students in this class.
- **QUIZZES AND EXAMS:** You will be given online quizzes each week. These will be specific to the content (reading and videos) for that week. Each quiz will have a total of 10 multiple choice questions and have a ten-minute window for completion. These are not meant to be overly complex, but they will absolutely require you to be familiar with the content provided that week. I'm sure there will be students who take these quizzes hoping to find the material in the reading as they go. While this could be a successful strategy you should bear in mind that 1) these are the primary source of points for this class, 2) the quizzes are timed, and 3) there are no retakes (1 attempt). The reading isn't too complicated and the videos are short. I strongly encourage students to properly prepare before taking each quiz.

There will be three "**Exams**" in this course. For each exam students are asked to create a PowerPoint lecture on a specific topic. These lectures must range from 15-20 slides, include images which support the content of each slide, and include presenter notes (at least a paragraph per slide) which provides a more thorough explanation of the material in the slide and/or the primary purpose of the slide. Check the important documents module on our course website to find a specific breakdown of how to navigate these assignments.

Grading

There are 120 possible points and their distribution is as follows:

Exam 1	20
Exam 2	20
Exam 3	20
Quizzes (n=14)	<u>140</u>

TOTAL 200

Grade	Percentage	Grade	Percentage
A+	98-100	A	90-97
B+	87-89	B	80-86
C+	77-79	C	70-76
D+	67-69	D	60-66
		F	59 or lower

Plagiarism.

It is expected that all assignments submitted for academic credit will be the student's own. In writing, students should be careful to use their own words. Quotations must be placed properly within quotation marks and must be cited fully. Students who are in any doubt about the preparation of their assignment should consult their instructor and TA. Students who, for whatever reason, submit work either not their own or without clear attribution to its sources will be subject to disciplinary action. Any student who submits work provided by AI, a commercial tutoring school, or a term paper company is also subject to disciplinary action.

Exam Policy: All students are required to take the exams in class on the day they are scheduled. If you miss an exam without a written medical excuse, **you will not be able to make up the exam.** All other exceptions will be considered on an individual basis. If you need to reschedule an exam because of travel commitments, you must contact your TA **at least two weeks before your travel.** Kokua students are responsible for making sure that Kokua contacts the instructor at least two weeks prior to the exam to make the necessary arrangements.

FERPA law compliance. This course space is being shared by students in the following CRNs [81221, 82363, 82364, 82365, 82366, 82367] and if you do not wish to be in a shared course space, please drop this section and register for another section or alternate course.

Class Schedule and Reading Assignments

PART ONE HUMAN EVOLUTION

Week 1 What is Evolution?

8/24-08/29

Quiz 1

Week 2

8/30-9/05

Humans as Primates/Primate Diversity

Quiz 2

Week 3

9/06-9/12

Paleoanthropology

Quiz 3

Week 4

9/13-9/19

Early Hominins and the rise of the Genus *Homo*

Quiz 4

Week 5

9/20-9/26

Neanderthals, Denisovans, and *Homo sapiens*

Quiz 5

Week 6

9/27-10/03

Exam 1

PART TWO THE ARCHAEOLOGY OF HUMAN MIGRATIONS

Week 7

10/04-10/10

Understanding Time: Establishing a Temporal Context

Quiz 6

Week 8

10/11-10/17

Understanding Climate: Establishing an Environmental Context

Quiz 7

Week 9

10/18-10/24

Migrations out of Africa

Quiz 8

Week 10

10/25-10/31

Peopling of North America

Quiz 9

Week 11

11/01-11/07

Peopling of Polynesia

Quiz 10

Week 12

11/08-11/14

Exam 2

PART 3

COMPLEX SOCIETIES: MESOPOTAMIA AND HAWAI'I

Week 13

11/15-11/21

Classification in Archaeology

Quiz 11

Week 14

11/22-11/28

The Neolithic Revolution

Quiz 12

Week 15

11/29-12/05

Social Complexity in Mesopotamia

Quiz 13

Week 16

12/06-12/12

The Hawaiian Archaic State

Quiz 14

Week 17
12/13-12/19

Final Exam

Learning Outcomes

- 1) Students will learn to critically evaluate and explain the process of human evolution.
- 2) Students will gain a global perspective on the rise and fall of ancient complex societies.
- 3) Students will learn how to apply their knowledge of ancient societies to current issues in the modern world.
- 4) Students will gain an appreciation for cultural diversity and how this diversity arose.